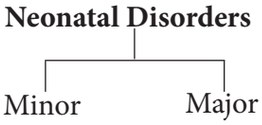

6.8.1 Minor Disorders of the Newborn

a. **Molding:** The head may appear asymmetric in the new born of a vertex birth caused by the over riding of the cranial bones during labour and birth. Diminishes within few days after birth.

b. **Stuffy Nose:** Stuffy nose leads to mouth breathing and excessive air swallowing which leads to abdominal distension and vomiting. Cleaning the nostrils with cotton swabs socked with normal saline will reduce the problem.

c. **Thrush:** Thrush may be oral or in the napkin area including buttocks and inner thighs. Treatment is 1% G.V paint or Nystatin suspension applied with cotton swabs.

d. **Phimosis:** Pinpoint prepuce which makes the baby cry during micturition. It requires dilatation by mosquito forceps.

e. **Mangolian Spots:** Bluish black areas of pigmentation more commonly noted on the back and buttocks. They fade gradually all over months or years.

f. **Nevi :** Telengiectatic nevi are pink and easily planched. They may appear on the upper eyelids, nose, upper lip and nap of the neck. They have no clinical significance and fade my second year of life.

g. **Physiological Jaundice:** 40% of term neonates and 60% of preterm neonates develop physiological jaundice. Jaundice becomes visible on second and third day. Usually peaking between the second and fourth day and decreasing between 5th and 7th days of life. It is believed to be the result of increased bilirubin production from the break down of foetal RBCs. Treatment is not necessary, but some children may need phototherapy.

h. **Pseudo Menstruation:** Pseudo menstruation or vaginal bleeding is caused by pregnancy hormones. It resolves when maternal hormones deplete from neonates body. Reassure the parents.

i. **Vomiting:** Many newborns vomit, be alert indicate a bowel obstruction which needs attention. Vomi of blood vomit, vomiting green - bile can ting can be due to motion sickness or indigestion.

j. **Dehydration:** The water content in the body reduces resulting in dehydration. When babies suffer from health problems like cold, cough or throat infection, the intake reduces and resulting in dehydration.

k. **Diarrhoea:** The poop is normally much softer than an adult, if it suddenly gets much looser or more watery and happens more often and in large amounts it may be diarrhoea. An infection with a virus, bacteria or parasite. Babies can get dehydrated very quickly within a day or two after diarrhoea starts. Continue breast feeding or formula feeding. Small amounts of hydrating solutions should be given frequently.

l. **Cord infection :** Infection of the umbilical cord stump is called as omphalitis. It can be caused by skin bacteria. Application of an antiseptic to umbilical cord is a best treatment.

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